

Buttons, line-edit fields, lists, and other clickable things in dialogs are known as controls. You set the controls the way you want them, then you activate the dialog by clicking the “OK” button or dismiss it by clicking “Cancel.” We’ll be providing specific examples of how to fill in and use the various dialogs you’ll encounter; for now, it’s enough just to understand in general terms how the parts of a dialog work.

➡ **Shortcut**

System 6 allows you to select items from the lists (and select line-edit fields to type data into) using the keyboard. Press the Tab key to move from one list (or field) to the next; a bold black box surrounds the field you’re editing. Use the up and down arrows to select the options in the list. Hold down the ⌘ key while you press Tab to move to the previous list (or field).

Using Check Boxes & Radio Buttons

The Finder’s Preferences dialog (Figure 5H) shows another type of dialog element—the check box. You generally use check boxes to turn a program’s features on and off—the Preferences dialog is pretty typical. Clicking a check box turns it off if it’s on—marked with an X—or on if it’s off. (It’s the old toggle effect again, which we last saw in the discussion of check marks in the pull-down menus section.)

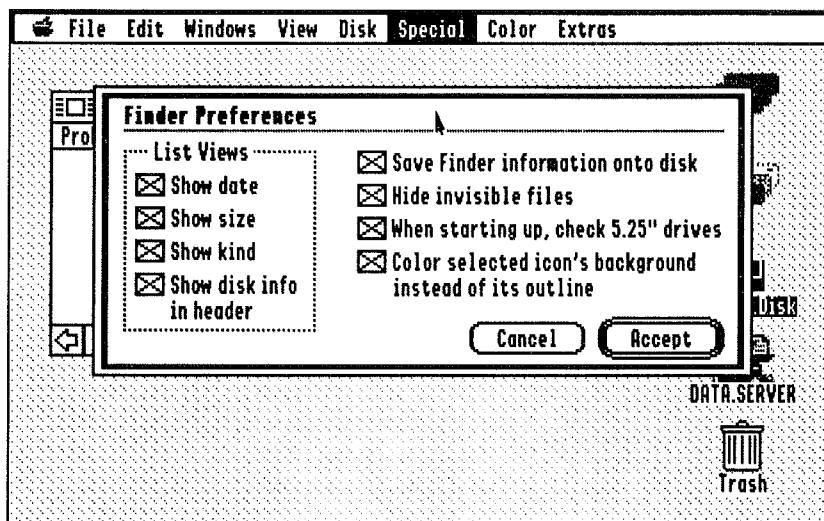


Figure 5H—Sample Check Boxes (Preferences, from Finder)

The Shut Down dialog (Figure 5J) shows the radio buttons—so named because they act like the buttons used to choose your favorite stations on car radios. As with the real radio buttons, you can choose only one option at a time—the options are mutually exclusive: that is, choosing one automatically means that you are rejecting the others. (This makes logical sense—with your car radio, you can’t listen to more than one station at a time, either.)